



HIRE driver japan · Academy

Complete programme

VVIP Service Training · Instructor's Programme

OCTOBER 2026 EDITION

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For instructors and staff. Not for distribution to trainees.

How to use this programme

This programme is for the instructor delivering the HIRE driver japan VVIP service training. It sets out the three-day structure, the rules that must be taught in every chapter, teaching notes, exercises, exam marking criteria and the checklists used on the job.

Trainees are drivers employed by hire and taxi operators, up to five per session. Training takes place at the operator's depot; days 1 and 2 can also be delivered by Zoom or Google Meet. Day 3, the in-car practice and practical exam, always takes place on site with the trainees' own vehicles.

The teaching method is: state the rule, give the reason, demonstrate it, have them do it. The rules marked as mandatory in each chapter are exactly what the exams test. Instructors may change the order and the examples, not the rules.

◆ What the instructor brings

- ☐ This programme and the trainees' study texts (one PDF per chapter)
- ☐ Sample name boards (real name and code sign)
- ☐ A full sample minibar and amenity kit (as listed in Appendix C)
- ☐ A cabin thermometer and unscented cleaning products
- ☐ Two large plain black umbrellas
- ☐ Printed copies of the appendix checklists for every trainee
- ☐ Marking sheets (oral and practical) for every trainee

The three-day structure

Seven teaching hours a day, excluding breaks: a 60-minute lunch and a 10-minute break in each half.

◆ Day 1 · The VVIP standard (Japanese or English)

09:00	Opening, introductions, aims of the course and how the exams work
09:30	Ch. 1 · What the VVIP standard means
10:15	Ch. 2 · Western and Middle Eastern clients
11:10	Ch. 3 · Driver preparation (grooming, odours, kit)
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Ch. 4 · Vehicle preparation (checks, cleaning, odours, airing, temperature)
14:00	Ch. 5 · Minibar and amenities
14:40	Ch. 6 · The name board
15:10	Ch. 7 · Preparing the itinerary
15:50	Ch. 8 · Greeting, doors, seating, luggage, rain
16:40	Ch. 9 · Conduct in the car: do not initiate
17:20	Ch. 10 · Confidentiality and social media / Ch. 11 · Assistants and security / Ch. 12 · The unexpected
18:00	Day 1 review and written-exam scope

◆ Day 2 · Service language (mainly English)

09:00	Ch. 13 · The 60 phrases (situations 1 to 4)
10:30	Ch. 14 · Pronunciation practice
11:15	Ch. 13 continued · Phrases (situations 5 to 7)
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Ch. 15 · Role play: airport and hotel
14:30	Ch. 16 · Role play: restaurant, shopping, emergencies
16:00	Ch. 17 · Using translation apps properly
16:30	Ch. 18 · Confirmation, delay and apology messages
17:15	Oral exam format and a mock exam
18:00	Day 2 review

◆ Day 3 · In-car practice and exams

09:00	Prepare the vehicles for real (practical of chapters 4 and 5)
10:00	Scenario 1 · Airport pickup to drop-off (instructor plays the client)
11:00	Scenario 2 · Hotel pickup in the rain, a client with shopping
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Scenario 3 · A ride with a security team, a sudden change of plan
14:00	Scenario 4 · Emergencies (illness, traffic)
14:45	Practical exam (20 to 25 minutes per trainee)
16:45	Oral exam (10 minutes per trainee)
17:40	Feedback, attestation, and how to take the written exam online

What the VVIP standard means

GOALS

- Explain who VVIP clients are and what they expect.
- State the difference between good service and the VVIP standard.

MANDATORY RULES

The priorities, always in this order: safety, confidentiality, comfort, professional conduct.

The driver is invisible: present the moment they are needed, unnoticed the rest of the time.

The ideal ride: the client arrives safely and on time, undisturbed, free to work or rest, never forced into conversation.

TEACHING NOTES

Open by handing out Appendix D, the expectations written by a real client's office, and say so: trainees then see the rules as a market requirement, not the instructor's taste.

Prepare two examples of a small slip that loses the next booking (a scent, a delay with no message).

EXERCISE

Each trainee names one reason a client never came back; the group sorts them under the four priorities.

COMMON MISTAKES

Believing service means entertaining the client. For VVIPs, quiet is the service.

Western and Middle Eastern clients

GOALS

- Know how expectations differ by culture and avoid offence.
- Make it a habit to confirm the unknown with the assistant beforehand.

MANDATORY RULES

Western clients: handshake and eye contact, Mr. or Ms. plus surname. Punctual; they want to hear about a delay before the reason.

Personal space: no touching, no standing too close. Even with luggage, ask first.

Middle East: prayer times, halal, Ramadan, customs on men and women sharing a car or shaking hands. A male driver never offers a handshake to a female client.

Confirm customs with the assistant in advance, through dispatch, never with the client.

Never judge by nationality. When unsure, choose the more formal and more discreet option.

TEACHING NOTES

Wealthy Gulf clients place particular weight on an invisible driver and a silent cabin. Rules 2 (conversation) and 5 (smell) in Appendix D say exactly that.

EXERCISE

Hand out three profiles (a US executive, a Saudi family, a French couple); each team writes the five questions to ask the assistant in advance.

COMMON MISTAKES

Asking 'Where are you from?' as friendly small talk. Personal questions are forbidden.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 3

Driver preparation: grooming, odours, kit

GOALS

- Bring yourself to five-star standard before every job.

MANDATORY RULES

The driver is scent-free. No perfume, cologne, strongly scented fabric softener or scented hair products.

No smoking before or during a job: it stays on clothes and in the car.

No strong-smelling food (garlic, onion, curry, fried food) before or during a job. No eating or chewing gum in the car on duty.

Check breath and hands: brush teeth, use a mint and wash hands before the job.

Dress: dark suit, white shirt, quiet tie, polished shoes. No creases, stains, sportswear, flashy watches or jewellery.

Hair, beard and nails neat. Arrive rested and well.

Phone on silent. No personal calls or phone use while on duty, except in an emergency.

Kit: licence, itinerary, contact sheet, name board, umbrella, a spare shirt, mints, two handkerchiefs.

TEACHING NOTES

People cannot smell themselves. Recommend asking a family member or colleague.

Define scent-free concretely: nothing beyond clean soap.

EXERCISE

Trainees check each other with Appendix A and each names one thing to fix.

COMMON MISTAKES

Thinking a little perfume is fine. In a closed cabin, a little is strong.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 4

Vehicle preparation: checks, cleaning, odours, airing, temperature

GOALS

- Have the vehicle completely ready before the client steps in.
- Control cabin odour and temperature yourself.

MANDATORY RULES

Technical check: fuel or charge sufficient; tyres, lights, wipers, washer fluid and air conditioning working.

Exterior washed, wheels and glass clean. Interior: seats, footwells, door pockets, inside glass, mirrors and boot. Fingerprints, hair and grit are noticed.

The cabin is scent-free. No air fresheners, scented sprays, tobacco or food smells. Use unscented cleaning products.

No eating or drinking in the car. No food brought into the cabin, apart from the minibar stock.

Airing: while the client is away, open the windows every 15 minutes. Always air the cabin once before the client boards.

Temperature: set the cabin to 23°C at least ten minutes before boarding, or to the client's stated preference. Hold 23°C during the ride; change it only when the client asks.

Music, radio and satnav voice off. Sound only when the client asks for it.

The driver's personal items (drinks, bags, papers, chargers) out of the client's sight, not even on the front seat.

Clean before every job and tick Appendix B.

TEACHING NOTES

'Every 15 minutes' is a concrete number for drivers who lose track of time on their phones while waiting. Have them use a timer.

23°C is a figure actually specified by a client's office (Appendix D, rule 4).

Put a thermometer in the cabin and show the gap between the display and the real temperature.

EXERCISE

On the morning of day 3 each trainee prepares their vehicle to Appendix B; the instructor checks glass and seat gaps by hand.

COMMON MISTAKES

Using an air freshener to make it 'smell nice'. The target is no smell, not a nice smell.

Starting the engine and leaving at once, so the cabin is hot or cold when the client boards.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 5

Minibar and amenities

GOALS

- Stock the standard amenities in the right place and condition.

MANDATORY RULES

Standard minibar: still water (room temperature and chilled), canned or bottled tea and coffee, soft drinks, chocolates and candies, orange-scented refreshing towels (chilled).

Amenities: tissues, wet wipes, charging cables (USB-C and Lightning), two umbrellas, a blanket, mints, a phone stand, a travel adaptor, a first-aid kit, a rubbish bag.

Drinks unopened, labels facing forward, lined up. Check use-by dates before every job.

Within the client's reach. Mention once after boarding: 'There is water and a charging cable here, please help yourself.'

Offer the towel on boarding: chilled in summer, warm in winter.

Restock after every job; anything used is replaced before the next client.

TEACHING NOTES

Lay the full sample kit on a table and have trainees arrange it correctly. Let them photograph it to reproduce at the depot.

Canned or bottled Japanese tea and coffee are fine; never serve hot drinks in the car because of scalding risk.

EXERCISE

Set up a vehicle minibar from scratch in five minutes, timed by the instructor.

COMMON MISTAKES

Keeping drinks in the boot. Out of reach, they do not exist.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 6

The name board

GOALS

- Greet correctly at airports and hotels while protecting the client.

MANDATORY RULES

White board, bold black printed letters, A4. No handwriting, no marks. Company or brand logo small.

Normal clients: Mr. or Ms. plus surname. Never the full name.

Clients with security, public figures: never the real name. Use a code name or signal agreed with the assistant. A real name reveals where they are.

Hold it at chest height, with both hands, straight. Never while looking at a phone.

Stand where the exit is visible without blocking the flow. Never call out in front of the exit.

In position 30 minutes before arrival; check the flight for delays and report to dispatch.

TEACHING NOTES

Show two samples: a correct one (Mr. Smith) and a wrong one (full name and company in large letters).

EXERCISE

From three client profiles, trainees decide what each name board should say.

COMMON MISTAKES

Writing the full name and flight number for anyone to read.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 7

Preparing the itinerary

GOALS

- Read the operating plan and prepare the itinerary completely before the job.

MANDATORY RULES

Receive the itinerary the day before and check times, places, companions, language and special instructions. Ask dispatch about anything unclear, the day before.

Check pickup and drop-off points in advance. Visit new places if possible; at the least, check entrances, forecourts and stopping points on the map.

Prepare a main route and an alternative. Check traffic and weather on the morning of the job.

Buffers: arrive 30 minutes before a pickup; estimate journeys at 20% more than the usual time.

Decide waiting spots and parking in advance. Never sit for long at a main entrance.

Carry the contact sheet (dispatch, assistant, security lead) on paper as well. A dead battery is no excuse.

Changes during the job: contact dispatch and get approval before acting.

TEACHING NOTES

Teach clearly here that the driver works under the company's instructions. Trainees do not need the legal theory; the habit 'even if the assistant tells me directly, dispatch first' is tested.

EXERCISE

Hand out a real one-day itinerary with a hotel and an airport; trainees add buffers, alternative routes and waiting spots.

COMMON MISTAKES

Relying on the satnav with no alternative. The moment traffic stops, there are no options.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 8

Greeting, doors, seating, luggage, rain

GOALS

- Perform the sequence from greeting to boarding safely and gracefully.
- Handle rain and a client with shopping.

MANDATORY RULES

The first words: introduce yourself, welcome them, guide them to luggage and car. That is enough.

Open the door only when fully stopped and after checking behind and around; walk round, hand on the frame, warn about the roof edge. Close gently and fully after checking hands, feet and clothing.

Confirm seating in advance. If unknown, gesture to the rear seats and let the client choose.

The driver loads and unloads. Ask whether the client wants to keep a bag of valuables with them.

Shopping bags: never let the client carry them. Say 'Let me take those', load them in the boot or where the client prefers so they cannot tip over, and ask whether fragile items should stay with the client.

Rain: have the umbrella open before the client leaves the building. The umbrella covers the client; the driver may get wet. Walk beside the client to the car, or to the next cover. Open the door first, then close the umbrella. Same on arrival.

Two large black umbrellas: one for the client, one for a companion.

Drop-off: announce 'We will arrive in one minute', open the door after stopping, check for items left behind.

TEACHING NOTES

This chapter is the first scenario on day 3. For the rain scenario, make them do it for real; a watering can or hose is not excessive.

Demonstrate the umbrella angle: tilted towards the driver so the client's shoulders stay dry.

EXERCISE

In the car park, each trainee performs greeting to boarding to drop-off; the others score with Appendix A.

COMMON MISTAKES

Holding the umbrella so the driver stays dry.

Watching the client board with their own shopping bags.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 9

Conduct in the car: do not initiate

GOALS

- Understand and practise silence as a service.

MANDATORY RULES

Never start a conversation unless the client does. No small talk, personal stories or unnecessary questions.

If the client starts a conversation, answer politely, briefly and professionally. No personal questions. Opinions and advice only when clearly asked.

Never comment on the client's calls, meetings, schedule, mood or private matters.

The driver may only speak about safety, the arrival announcement, changes of plan and traffic that changes the timing. Conclusion and time first, in one sentence.

Never interrupt a call or work. Tell them at arrival if needed.

Do not turn round to the client. Phone on silent and untouched. No eating, no gum.

Drive smoothly: no sudden braking, acceleration, lane changes or speeding. Smooth enough for the client to read.

Keep a professional distance. Do not try to build rapport.

TEACHING NOTES

Many Japanese taxi drivers were taught that silence is rude. State the opposite standard clearly here; reading rules 2, 9 and 12 of Appendix D aloud works well.

Practise 'one sentence': traffic, route change and arrival announcement, each in 15 words or fewer.

EXERCISE

A 30-minute mock ride with the instructor as client (chairs will do). The instructor takes a call, reads papers and asks one question. Note when the trainee should and should not speak.

COMMON MISTAKES

Unable to bear silence, starting on the weather or sightseeing.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 10

Confidentiality and social media

GOALS

- Explain what confidentiality covers and what is dangerous on social media.

MANDATORY RULES

Everything seen or heard on duty is confidential: names, destinations, times, companions, conversations, calls, documents in the car.

Tell no one: family, friends, colleagues, other clients, social media. Leaving out the name is not enough.

No photos, videos or recordings of any kind: not the client, the cabin, the car outside the hotel or the destination. No posting, even afterwards.

No location data, location tags or live streaming on duty.

Never ask a famous client for an autograph or selfie. If asked to take a photo, only on the client's device.

Never read documents in the car. Keep lost items unopened under company procedure and report at once.

If the press or anyone asks, say only 'I cannot comment' and report to the company. The duty continues after the job.

TEACHING NOTES

Prepare three examples of posts that look harmless (a hotel forecourt photo, 'drove someone famous today', a luxury car with a timestamp).

EXERCISE

Show the three posts; trainees explain who could identify the client from each.

COMMON MISTAKES

'It's fine without the name.' Car, place and time identify the client.

Working with assistants, security and family offices

GOALS

- Know whose instructions to follow and to whom to report.

MANDATORY RULES

The driver works under the company's instructions. Itinerary changes go through dispatch.

Assistants: advance information comes through the company; small updates during the job, such as departure times, may come directly.

Security: the security lead decides routes, stopping points and the order of getting in and out. Never change route on your own.

Family offices: detailed instructions such as school runs and activities. Take notes and repeat back.

Report start, end, delays and anything unexpected to the company, briefly and precisely.

TEACHING NOTES

Security rides are practised in scenario 3 on day 3. Here, write the order on the board, such as never getting out before security to open the door.

EXERCISE

Act out the assistant adding a destination mid-ride; the trainee performs the correct steps (call dispatch for approval).

COMMON MISTAKES

Following the assistant's instruction on the spot, meaning well, and not telling the company.

The unexpected

GOALS

- Act calmly: safety, communication, then alternatives.

MANDATORY RULES

Delays: as soon as known, tell the assistant and the company with a new arrival time. Reason short, with an apology.

Illness: stop safely, check consciousness and breathing; call 119 if needed, then the assistant and the company.

Accidents: secure the client, call 110 and the company. Onward travel is arranged through the company.

Vehicle fault: stop safely, call the company for a replacement. Tell the client briefly what is happening and what happens next.

Changes of plan: get dispatch approval before acting.

Lost items: keep unopened, tell the company and the assistant at once.

In every case: stay calm, inform the client briefly and clearly, offer a practical solution, add no stress.

TEACHING NOTES

Have them memorise the emergency numbers (110, 119, 118) and the company's emergency line.

EXERCISE

Draw a card (traffic, illness, puncture, added destination) and state the first three actions within 30 seconds.

COMMON MISTAKES

Calling once the delay is certain. Call the moment it becomes likely.

Day 2 · Service language

The goal of day 2 is not fluency: it is handling nine situations in ten with 60 phrases, pronounced clearly. The material is the same as trainees' chapters 12 to 19. This section gives the method and the marking criteria.

◆ Method

- Each phrase three times: instructor says it, all repeat, each trainee says it alone. Ten minutes per situation.
- Pronunciation starts with the ten words of chapter 14: no vowel on the end, stress in the right place.
- Role plays with the instructor as client: once with the script, once without, with one unexpected question.
- Have them actually use a translation app, including rephrasing so that names and destinations are never typed.
- Have them write the three message types for real and correct them.

◆ Oral exam marking (100 points)

Greeting and guiding (ch. 13, situations 1 to 2)	25
Information and confirmation during the ride (situations 3 to 5)	25
Apologies and emergencies (situation 6)	20
Pronunciation and clarity	20
Handling an unexpected question (ask again, ask them to write, confirm on screen)	10

Pass mark 70. Grammar mistakes are not penalised if the meaning gets through; unclear pronunciation and freezing into silence are.

◆ The 60 phrases (as in trainees' chapter 12)

Greeting

1	Good morning. Welcome to Tokyo.
2	I am your driver today. My name is ____.
3	Mr. Smith? I am here to pick you up.
4	How was your flight?
5	The car is just outside. Please follow me.
6	Please take your time.
7	Is anyone else joining us?

8	Here is the car.
9	Please watch your head.
10	Is the temperature comfortable?

Luggage

1	May I take your luggage?
2	Would you like to keep this bag with you?

3	How many pieces of luggage do you have?
4	I will put your luggage in the trunk.
5	Let me carry it for you. It is heavy.
6	Is this everything?
7	I will bring your luggage to the lobby.
8	Please check you have all your belongings.

During the ride

1	We will leave now.
2	It will take about 40 minutes.
3	There is water here. Please help yourself.
4	Here is a charging cable if you need one.
5	Would you like some music, or would you prefer quiet?
6	Please let me know if you need anything.
7	There is some traffic ahead.
8	We are slightly delayed because of traffic.
9	We will arrive at around 7:15.
10	May I confirm your next destination?
11	Shall I take the expressway?
12	We will arrive in one minute.

Arrival

1	We have arrived.
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2	Please wait a moment. I will open the door.
3	Please mind your step.
4	Here is the entrance.
5	What time shall I pick you up?
6	I will wait for you here.
7	Please call me when you are ready.
8	Here is my contact number.

Waiting and confirming

1	I am waiting at the main entrance.
2	I will be there in five minutes.
3	The car is ready.
4	Could you say that again, please?
5	Could you write it down, please?
6	Let me check on the map.
7	Is this the right address?
8	I will confirm with my office.

Apologies and emergencies

1	I am very sorry for the delay.
2	I am sorry for the inconvenience.
3	Are you all right?
4	Shall I call an ambulance?
5	I will stop the car in a safe place.
6	I will contact your assistant.
7	Please stay in the car.

8	Help is on the way.	3	Have a safe flight.
Farewell		4	Enjoy your stay in Tokyo.
1	Thank you very much.	5	I hope to see you again.
2	It was a pleasure to drive you.	6	Have a good evening.

◆ Ten words often mispronounced

Word	Stress
hotel	ho-TEL
luggage	LUG-gidge
terminal	TER-mi-nal
schedule	SKED-jool / SHED-yool
restaurant	RES-tuh-ront
airport	AIR-port
receipt	ri-SEET
escalator	ES-ka-lay-ter
expressway	ik-SPRESS-way
driver	DRY-ver

◆ Role-play scripts

Model dialogue

Driver	Good evening. Mr. Smith? Welcome to Tokyo.
Client	Yes, thank you.
Driver	I am your driver today. May I take your luggage?
Client	Thanks. I'll keep this bag.
Driver	Of course. The car is just outside. Please follow me.
Driver	It will take about 40 minutes to your hotel. There is water here. Please help yourself.

Client Great. Can I charge my phone?

Driver Yes, here is a cable.

Model dialogue

Driver We have arrived at your hotel. Please wait a moment, I will open the door.

Client What time tomorrow?

Driver Your first meeting is at nine. May I pick you up at 8:30 here at the main entrance?

Client Perfect.

Driver 8:30 at the main entrance. Have a good evening.

Model dialogue

Driver Here is the restaurant. I cannot wait at the entrance, so I will wait nearby.

Driver Please call me ten minutes before you leave. I will be here in ten minutes.

Client How long to the next shop?

Driver About fifteen minutes by car.

Model dialogue: feeling unwell

Client I don't feel well.

Driver I will stop the car in a safe place. Are you all right?

Driver Shall I call an ambulance?

Driver Help is on the way. I will contact your assistant now.

Model dialogue: traffic

Driver I am sorry, there is an accident ahead. We will arrive about twenty minutes late, at around 3:40.

Driver Shall I inform your assistant?

Day 3 · In-car practice and exams

The instructor plays the client. Each scenario runs from preparation (vehicle, grooming) through greeting, boarding, the ride, drop-off and the report. The instructor deliberately introduces something unexpected.

◆ Scenario 1 · Airport pickup

Greeting with the name board, three bags, 40 minutes to the hotel. During the ride the instructor takes a call and asks once 'What time will we arrive?'. Watch: name board wording and hold, first words, luggage, doors, 23°C, the minibar mentioned once, no initiating, the one-minute announcement.

◆ Scenario 2 · Hotel pickup in the rain, with shopping

Rain at the hotel forecourt (real water is fine). The instructor comes out with four shopping bags. Watch: umbrella open in advance, umbrella angle, taking the bags, asking about fragile items, loading so nothing tips, door first then umbrella down, the same on arrival.

◆ Scenario 3 · A security ride and a change of plan

One trainee plays security. Mid-ride, the 'assistant' calls to add a destination. Watch: the order of getting in and out, no unilateral route change, calling dispatch (the instructor's phone) for approval, the choice of waiting spot.

◆ Scenario 4 · Emergencies

The instructor says 'I don't feel well' during the ride; in another run, traffic causes a 20-minute delay. Watch: safe stop, checks, the decision to call 119, informing the assistant and the company, a short explanation to the client with the next step, the English phrases.

◆ Practical exam marking (100 points)

Vehicle preparation: clean, scent-free, aired, 23°C, amenities, no personal items	20
Grooming and no scent	10
Greeting, name board, first words	10
Doors, seating, luggage, shopping bags, umbrella	20
Smooth, safe driving	10
Conduct: no initiating, one-sentence updates, phone untouched	15
Handling the unexpected and contacting the company	15

Pass mark 70. Regardless of score, any of the following fails: opening a door without a safety check, using the phone on duty, disclosing client information, a smell of perfume or tobacco.

Exams, attestation and certification

- Written exam: online in the HDJ Academy, 20 questions drawn from a bank of 25, 30 minutes, pass mark 70, answer order shuffled each attempt. Two attempts included; a retake within 60 days is free.
- Oral exam: day 3, ten minutes per trainee, instructor as client, marked to the day 2 criteria.
- Practical exam: day 3, 20 to 25 minutes per trainee, in the trainee's vehicle, marked to the day 3 criteria.
- Attestation of Completion: for everyone who attends every day. No expiry.
- VVIP Service Certificate: only for drivers who pass all three exams. Valid two years, renewed with a one-day refresher. Verifiable by number and QR code at hiredriverjapan.com/verify.
- The instructor sends the marking sheets to HIRE driver japan on the day. Certificates are issued by head office.

Appendix A · Pre-departure checklist (the driver)

- ☐ Rested and well
- ☐ Teeth brushed, mint, no bad breath
- ☐ Hands washed, nails short
- ☐ No perfume, scented hair product or fabric softener
- ☐ No tobacco smell (no smoking before the job)
- ☐ No strong-smelling food
- ☐ Suit uncreased and clean, white shirt, shoes polished
- ☐ Hair and beard neat
- ☐ Phone on silent, fully charged
- ☐ Licence, itinerary, contact sheet (paper)
- ☐ Name board (wording checked)
- ☐ Two umbrellas, spare shirt, two handkerchiefs

Appendix B · Vehicle preparation checklist

◆ Checks

- ☐ Fuel or charge sufficient
- ☐ Tyres, lights, wipers, washer fluid
- ☐ Air conditioning working, set to 23°C

◆ Exterior

- ☐ Washed; wheels and glass clean
- ☐ Number plates clean

◆ Interior

- ☐ Seats, footwells, door pockets and boot cleaned
- ☐ No fingerprints on inside glass or mirrors
- ☐ No hair, grit or rubbish
- ☐ Scent-free (no freshener, food or tobacco)
- ☐ Aired (every 15 minutes while waiting)
- ☐ Driver's personal items out of sight
- ☐ Music, radio and satnav voice off

◆ Before leaving

- ☐ Minibar and amenities restocked to Appendix C
- ☐ Itinerary, alternative route and waiting spot checked
- ☐ Traffic and weather checked
- ☐ Departure time that gets you there 30 minutes early

Appendix C · Minibar and amenity list

◆ Drinks (unopened, labels forward)

- ☐ Still water: two at room temperature, two chilled
- ☐ Tea, canned or bottled: two
- ☐ Coffee, canned or bottled: two
- ☐ Soft drinks: two

◆ Sweets

- ☐ Chocolates, individually wrapped
- ☐ Candies, individually wrapped
- ☐ Mints

◆ Towels

- ☐ Orange-scented refreshing towels (chilled in summer, warm in winter)

◆ Amenities

- ☐ Tissues, wet wipes
- ☐ Charging cables: USB-C and Lightning
- ☐ Phone stand, travel adaptor
- ☐ Two large black umbrellas
- ☐ Blanket
- ☐ First-aid kit
- ☐ Rubbish bag (out of sight)

◆ Management

- ☐ Check use-by dates before every job
- ☐ Replace anything used before the next client

Appendix D · What a client actually asks for (driver guidelines issued by a Gulf CEO's office, 2026)

The following summarises, anonymised and within the permission given, the rules written by an overseas executive's office for its own drivers. Note how closely they match the HIRE driver japan standard.

◆ Priorities

Safety, confidentiality, passenger comfort, professional conduct.

◆ Communication

Do not initiate conversation unless necessary. No small talk, personal stories or unnecessary questions. Answer direct questions politely and briefly. No personal questions. No opinions or advice unless asked. No comments on calls, meetings, schedule, mood or private matters.

◆ Confidentiality

Everything seen, heard or learned is strictly confidential. Never discuss routes, meetings, conversations or schedule. No photos, videos or recordings. Nothing on social media. Never disclose where the passenger was, is going or whom they met.

◆ The vehicle

Clean inside and out, in excellent condition, fuelled, free of clutter, clean windows and mirrors, climate control working at 22 to 23°C. No trash, dust, strong odours, personal items, loud music or distracting objects.

◆ Smell

A clean, subtle, fresh and neutral smell. No strong fresheners, perfume, tobacco or food. Air the vehicle before the trip whenever possible.

◆ Appearance

Neat, clean, professional clothing and shoes. No casual or sporty clothes, creases, stains or strong perfume.

◆ Arrival and pickup

Arrive early with a buffer; the vehicle fully ready before the passenger enters. Confirm the time, place, route, traffic and the safest, most convenient pickup point beforehand.

◆ Driving

Smooth, safe, calm and predictable. Safety over speed; the most comfortable route, not only the fastest. No sudden acceleration, hard braking, aggressive lane changes, speeding or risky manoeuvres.

◆ During the ride

A calm, quiet cabin. Music only on request. Phone on silent, no personal calls except in an emergency. Eyes on the road; no turning round unnecessarily. No eating or chewing gum.

◆ Comfort

A comfortable temperature, clean seats, smooth driving, and quiet especially when the passenger is working or on a call. Bottled water, tissues, charging cables and a first-aid kit available.

◆ Smoking and food

Smoking in the vehicle is strictly prohibited, and not immediately before a trip. Avoid strong-smelling food.

◆ Distance

Polite, respectful and discreet. Never over-familiar. Do not try to build a personal rapport.

◆ The unexpected

Stay calm, inform briefly and clearly if necessary, offer a practical solution, add no stress, put safety first.

◆ Unacceptable

Being late, arguing, discussing internal company matters, phone use while driving, aggressive or illegal driving, rudeness or talkativeness, personal questions, disclosing information, bad smells, any unnecessary discomfort.

Instructor's card · The ten non-negotiables

1. Driver and cabin scent-free.
2. No food in the car. No tobacco or strong food before the job.
3. Air the cabin every 15 minutes while waiting, and once before boarding.
4. 23°C, ten minutes before boarding. Change it only when asked.
5. Never speak first.
6. Rain: umbrella open first, over the client, escort to cover. The driver may get wet.
7. Never let the client carry shopping; take it and load it.
8. Name board: Mr. or Ms. plus surname. With security, never the real name.
9. No photos, no posts, no talking. What you see and hear stays secret for life.
10. Changes of plan only with dispatch approval.

Cut out this page for the instructor and every trainee.